

JEFF HODGES

CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST

Digital Storytelling • Experience Design • Front-End Development

Portfolio | GitHub | LinkedIn | aikipezman@gmail.com | (940) 206-4715

I help artists, authors, educators, and cultural organizations translate meaningful work into distinctive digital experiences.

CAPABILITIES

- Creative direction
- Digital storytelling
- Experience / interface design
- Information architecture
- Content strategy
- Audience analysis
- Client discovery
- Visual identity systems

TECHNOLOGY

- HTML5 / CSS3
- JavaScript (ES6+)
- Responsive design
- CSS Grid / Flexbox
- DOM manipulation
- Accessibility fundamentals
- Git / GitHub / GitHub Pages
- VS Code / Chrome DevTools

EDUCATION

M.A. Musicology

Ethnomusicology University of North Texas, 2010

B.M. Music Education

University of North Texas, 1996

RECOGNITION

- Outstanding Student in Ethnomusicology, UNT
- UNT Summer Research Grant
- GISD Secondary Teacher of the Month

PROFILE

Creative technologist working at the intersection of technology, visual design, storytelling, and human experience. I begin with the idea, identity, audience, and purpose, then determine the digital form that best serves them. My practice combines front-end development with creative direction, information architecture, content strategy, research, and client consultation. I bring 25+ years of experience leading complex creative and educational projects, plus graduate training in ethnomusicology and cultural interpretation.

SELECTED CREATIVE TECHNOLOGY WORK

Kate Wurtzel - Artist Platform

CREATIVE DIRECTION • UX/UI • BRAND TRANSLATION • FRONT-END DEVELOPMENT

Translated an artist's mythic, nature-centered practice into a cohesive multi-page digital identity. Developed the visual direction and information architecture connecting artwork, workshops, writing, biography, and inquiries; built responsive gallery and content systems in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git, and GitHub Pages.

Karen Hodges - Author & Storyteller Platform

DIGITAL STORYTELLING • ARCHIVAL CURATION • UX/UI • FRONT-END DEVELOPMENT

Synthesized biography, regional identity, books, oral storytelling, archival imagery, essays, and reflections into a unified author platform. Created a visual language informed by literary and archival materials and built reusable, responsive reading experiences.

Elijahisms - Emerging Artist / Commerce Platform

IDENTITY DEVELOPMENT • EXPERIENCE STRATEGY • CREATIVE DIRECTION

Developing a platform that balances personal mythology, folklore, early-web nostalgia, video, artistic identity, usability, and future commerce. Clarified the project's identity before implementation and created a phased development strategy that can grow with the client's practice.

Eye*See / E-Portfolio

BRAND STRATEGY • WEB DESIGN • FRONT-END DEVELOPMENT

Building an independent creative-technology practice for artists, authors, educators, and small organizations whose work requires interpretation rather than template-driven web design.

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CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST / CREATIVE LEADERSHIP

WORKING APPROACH

- Discover the real problem before prescribing the medium
- Translate identity and narrative into structure
- Design for audience, context, and accessibility
- Prototype, build, test, and refine
- Use code as an expressive and practical tool

PROFESSIONAL VALUE

- 25+ years leading complex public-facing projects
- Experienced presenter and facilitator
- Cross-disciplinary research background
- Comfortable with clients and nontechnical stakeholders
- Creative direction through execution

LINKS

Portfolio

aikipezman-pixel.github.io/EPortfolioProject/

GitHub

github.com/aikipezman-pixel

LinkedIn

linkedin.com/in/jeff-hodges-17735a2b/

CREATIVE LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Director of Bands - Avery County Schools | 2022-Present

CREATIVE DIRECTION • PROGRAM LEADERSHIP • AUDIENCE EXPERIENCE

Lead a county-wide public arts program requiring creative direction, education, logistics, visual presentation, community engagement, budgeting, and long-range project management. Conceive productions integrating music, movement, visual identity, narrative, performers, technical constraints, and audience experience. Develop systems across multiple campuses and coordinate students, families, administrators, clinicians, and community partners.

Music Educator & Program Director - Texas Public Schools | 1996-2021

PROGRAM DESIGN • CURRICULUM • COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Held leadership and instructional positions including Lead Director at Ojeda Middle School and Assistant Director for Gainesville ISD and Krum ISD. Developed curricula, performances, jazz programs, recruiting initiatives, community events, and large-scale student experiences while managing the operational systems required to sustain them.

Teaching Assistant - University of North Texas | 2006-2009

POPULAR MUSIC • EDUCATIONAL MEDIA

Supported Popular Music in American Culture across large face-to-face and online sections. Reviewed written work, taught classes, maintained instructional systems, and assisted with recording and editing educational podcasts.

RESEARCH & CULTURAL PERSPECTIVE

Graduate specialization in ethnomusicology with academic interests in popular music, organology, globalization, and phenomenology. Presented research to the Society for Ethnomusicology Southern Plains chapter and participated in Balinese gamelan, West African, and cross-cultural Indian ensembles. This training informs a practice centered on context, interpretation, audience, and the meanings carried by design choices.

PERSPECTIVE

My path into technology began with decades of asking how ideas become experiences: how creative choices shape meaning, how audiences understand unfamiliar material, and how complex work can be organized without stripping away what makes it distinctive.

Code extends that practice. It does not define it.